

— THE SBV PROVEN PROCESS

Business Owner Client Checklist

18 questions to help you talk about the business with confidence. Work through the four steps with any owner client: know the value, protect it, grow it, and reap it with a plan for the exit. Tick each item when you have a clear answer.

STEP 01	Know	<i>Understand what the business is worth and what the owner needs.</i>
☐ 01	Get an independent market valuation	
☐ 02	Define the owner's number: after-tax proceeds needed for retirement	
☐ 03	Clarify exit goals and timeline: sale, family, employees or keep	
☐ 04	Know what buyers pay more for	
STEP 02	Protect	<i>Keep the value from disappearing when something changes.</i>
☐ 05	Be financially prepared	
☐ 06	Understand the hidden risk in your business	
☐ 07	Secure key employees with documented roles, employment agreements and long-term incentives	
☐ 08	Keep buy-sell and ownership agreements current, funded and formula-based	
☐ 09	Test owner dependence: could the business run 90 days without the owner?	
☐ 10	Two most common value killers: inconsistent revenue growth and personnel	
STEP 03	Grow	<i>Improve the drivers that raise value.</i>
☐ 11	Develop a growth plan that accelerates business value	
☐ 12	Connect key performance indicators (KPIs) to employee compensation plans	
☐ 13	Manage expenses with vigilance	
☐ 14	Measure what you manage	
STEP 04	Reap	<i>Plan for an exit with no regrets.</i>
☐ 15	Evaluate your plan every six months	
☐ 16	Line up your deal team early	
☐ 17	Address personal transition matters	
☐ 18	Align financial, personal and business readiness	

Why each item matters

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